
INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE

UNIT 1 ASPECTS OF DRAMATIC TRAGEDY

Monday 13 January 2020

07:00 GMT

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an Oxford AQA Exams 12-page answer book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book. The **Examining Body** for this paper is AQA.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work that you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **one** question from Section A and **one** question from Section B.
- Remember to include, in both your answers, relevant comments on the authors' dramatic methods in the set texts you are studying.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.

Section A: Elizabethan and Jacobean tragedy

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of different characters
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 3 Scene 4

DESDEMONA

Where should I lose the handkerchief, Emilia?

EMILIA

I know not, madam.

DESDEMONA

Believe me, I had rather have lost my purse
Full of crusadoes; and but my noble Moor
Is true of mind and made of no such baseness
As jealous creatures are, it were enough
To put him to ill thinking.

EMILIA

Is he not jealous?

DESDEMONA

Who, he? I think the sun where he was born
Drew all such humours from him.

EMILIA

Look, where he comes.

Enter Othello

DESDEMONA

I will not leave him now till Cassio
Be called to him. How is't with you, my lord?

OTHELLO

Well, my good lady. (*Aside*) O, hardness to dissemble! —
How do you, Desdemona?

DESDEMONA

Well, my good lord.

OTHELLO

Give me your hand. This hand is moist, my lady.

DESDEMONA

It yet hath felt no age, nor known no sorrow.

OTHELLO

This argues fruitfulness and liberal heart:
 Hot, hot and moist! This hand of yours requires
 A sequester from liberty — fasting and prayer,
 Much castigation, exercise devout —
 For here's a young and sweating devil here
 That commonly rebels. 'Tis a good hand,
 A frank one.

DESDEMONA

You may indeed say so;
 For 'twas that hand that gave away my heart.

OTHELLO

A liberal hand. The hearts of old gave hands,
 But our new heraldry is hands, not hearts.

DESDEMONA

I cannot speak of this. Come now, your promise.

OTHELLO

What promise, chuck?

DESDEMONA

I have sent to bid Cassio come speak with you.

OTHELLO

I have a salt and sorry rheum offends me:
 Lend me thy handkerchief.

DESDEMONA

Here, my lord.

OTHELLO

That which I gave you.

DESDEMONA

I have it not about me.

OTHELLO

Not?

DESDEMONA

No, faith, my lord.

OTHELLO

That's a fault: that handkerchief
 Did an Egyptian to my mother give;
 She was a charmer and could almost read
 The thoughts of people; she told her, while she kept it
 'Twould make her amiable and subdue my father
 Entirely to her love — but if she lost it,
 Or made gift of it, my father's eye
 Should hold her loathèd, and his spirits should hunt
 After new fancies. She dying gave it me
 And bid me, when my fate would have me wived,
 To give it her. I did so; and, take heed on't,
 Make it a darling like your precious eye:
 To lose't or give't away were such perdition
 As nothing else could match.

DESDEMONA

Is't possible?

Turn over for the next question

or

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Goneril and Albany
- Shakespeare's use of language
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 4 Scene 2

GONERIL

I have been worth the whistling.

ALBANY

O Goneril,
You are not worth the dust which the rude wind
Blows in your face. I fear your disposition.
That nature which contemns it origin
Cannot be bordered certain in itself.
She that herself will sliver and disbranch
From her material sap perforce must wither,
And come to deadly use.

GONERIL

No more. The text is foolish.

ALBANY

Wisdom and goodness to the vile seem vile;
Filths savour but themselves. What have you done?
Tigers, not daughters, what have you performed?
A father, and a gracious, aged man,
Whose reverence even the head-lugged bear would lick,
Most barbarous, most degenerate, have you madded.
Could my good-brother suffer you to do it —
A man, a prince by him so benefacted?
If that the heavens do not their visible spirits
Send quickly down to tame these vile offences,
It will come,
Humanity must perforce prey on itself,
Like monsters of the deep.

GONERIL

Milk-livered man,
That bear'st a cheek for blows, a head for wrongs;
Who hast not in thy brows an eye discerning
Thine honour from thy suffering; that not know'st
Fools do those villains pity who are punished
Ere they have done their mischief: where's thy drum?
France spreads his banners in our noiseless land,
With plumèd helm thy flaxen biggin threats,

Whiles thou, a moral fool, sits still and cries
'Alack, why does he so?'

ALBANY

See thyself, devil.
Proper deformity shows not in the fiend
So horrid as in woman.

GONERIL

O vain fool!

ALBANY

Thou changèd and self-covered thing, for shame
Bemonster not thy feature. Were't my fitness
To let these hands obey my blood,
They are apt enough to dislocate and tear
Thy flesh and bones. Howe'er thou art a fiend,
A woman's shape doth shield thee.

GONERIL

Marry, your manhood, mew —

Enter [Second] Gentleman

ALBANY

What news?

[SECOND] GENTLEMAN

O my good lord, the Duke of Cornwall's dead,
Slain by his servant going to put out
The other eye of Gloucester.

ALBANY

Gloucester's eyes?

[SECOND] GENTLEMAN

A servant that he bred, thrall'd with remorse,
Opposed against the act, bending his sword
To his great master, who thereat enraged
Flew on him, and amongst them felled him dead,
But not without that harmful stroke which since
Hath plucked him after.

ALBANY

This shows you are above,
You justicers, that these our nether crimes
So speedily can venge.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Hamlet
- Shakespeare's use of language
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 2 Scene 2

HAMLET

Ay, so, God buy you. Now I am alone.
 O, what a rogue and peasant slave am I!
 Is it not monstrous that this player here,
 But in a fiction, in a dream of passion,
 Could force his soul so to his whole conceit
 That from her working all his visage wanned,
 Tears in his eyes, distraction in's aspect,
 A broken voice, and his whole function suiting
 With forms to his conceit? And all for nothing.
 For Hecuba!
 What's Hecuba to him, or he to Hecuba,
 That he should weep for her? What would he do,
 Had he the motive and the cue for passion
 That I have? He would drown the stage with tears
 And cleave the general ear with horrid speech,
 Make mad the guilty and appal the free,
 Confound the ignorant and amaze indeed
 The very faculties of eyes and ears. Yet I,
 A dull and muddy-mettled rascal, peak
 Like John-a-dreams, unpregnant of my cause,
 And can say nothing; no, not for a king
 Upon whose property and most dear life
 A damned defeat was made. Am I a coward?
 Who calls me villain, breaks my pate across,
 Plucks off my beard and blows it in my face,
 Tweaks me by th' nose, gives me the lie i'th' throat
 As deep as to the lungs? Who does me this?
 Ha! 'Swounds, I should take it. For it cannot be
 But I am pigeon-livered and lack gall
 To make oppression bitter, or ere this
 I should have fatted all the region kites
 With this slave's offal. Bloody, bawdy villain!
 Remorseless, treacherous, lecherous, kindless villain!
 O, vengeance!

Why, what an ass am I! Ay, sure. This is most brave,
That I, the son of a dear father murdered,
Prompted to my revenge by heaven and hell,
Must, like a whore, unpack my heart with words,
And fall a-cursing like a very drab,
A scullion! Fie upon't, foh!
About, my brain. — I have heard
That guilty creatures sitting at a play
Have by the very cunning of the scene
Been struck so to the soul that presently
They have proclaimed their malefactions;
For murder, though it have no tongue, will speak
With most miraculous organ. I'll have these players
Play something like the murder of my father
Before mine uncle. I'll observe his looks,
I'll tent him to the quick. If he but blench,
I know my course. The spirit that I have seen
May be the devil, and the devil hath power
T'assume a pleasing shape; yea, and perhaps
Out of my weakness and my melancholy,
As he is very potent with such spirits,
Abuses me to damn me. I'll have grounds
More relative than this. The play's the thing
Wherein I'll catch the conscience of the King.

Exit

Turn over for the next question

or

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Faustus and Mephistopheles
- Marlowe's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 2 Scene 1

MEPHISTOPHELES

Speak, Faustus. Do you deliver this as your deed?

FAUSTUS [*giving the deed*]

Ay. Take it, and the devil give thee good of it.

MEPHISTOPHELES

So. Now, Faustus, ask me what thou wilt.

FAUSTUS

First I will question thee about hell.

Tell me, where is the place that men call hell?

MEPHISTOPHELES

Under the heavens.

FAUSTUS

Ay, so are all things else. But whereabouts?

MEPHISTOPHELES

Within the bowels of these elements,

Where we are tortured and remain for ever.

Hell hath no limits, nor is circumscribed

In one self place, but where we are is hell,

And where hell is there must we ever be.

And, to be short, when all the world dissolves,

And every creature shall be purified,

All places shall be hell that is not heaven.

FAUSTUS

I think hell's a fable.

MEPHISTOPHELES

Ay, think so still, till experience change thy mind.

FAUSTUS

Why, dost thou think that Faustus shall be damned?

MEPHISTOPHELES

Ay, of necessity, for here's the scroll

In which thou hast given thy soul to Lucifer.

FAUSTUS

Ay, and body too. But what of that?
Think'st thou that Faustus is so fond to imagine
That after this life there is any pain?
No, these are trifles and mere old wives' tales.

MEPHISTOPHELES

But I am an instance to prove the contrary,
For I tell thee I am damned and now in hell.

FAUSTUS

Nay, an this be hell, I'll willingly be damned.
What? Sleeping, eating, walking, and disputing?
But leaving this, let me have a wife, the fairest maid in Germany,
for I am wanton and lascivious and cannot live without a wife.

MEPHISTOPHELES

Well, Faustus, thou shalt have a wife.
He fetches in a woman Devil.

FAUSTUS

What sight is this?

MEPHISTOPHELES

Now, Faustus, wilt thou have a wife?

FAUSTUS

Here's a hot whore indeed! No, I'll no wife.

MEPHISTOPHELES

Marriage is but a ceremonial toy.
An if thou lovest me, think no more of it.

[Exit Devil]

I'll cull thee out the fairest courtesans
And bring them every morning to thy bed.
She whom thine eye shall like, thy heart shall have,
Were she as chaste as was Penelope,
As wise as Saba, or as beautiful
As was bright Lucifer before his fall.

[Presenting a book]

Here, take this book and peruse it well.
The iterating of these lines brings gold;
The framing of this circle on the ground
Brings thunder, whirlwinds, storm, and lightning.
Pronounce this thrice devoutly to thyself,
And men in harness shall appear to thee
Ready to execute what thou command'st.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	5
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John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the Duchess and Ferdinand
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 3 Scene 2

DUCHESS

Doth not the colour of my hair 'gin to change?
 When I wax grey, I shall have all the court
 Powder their hair with orris, to be like me.
 You have cause to love me: I entered you into my heart
[Enter Ferdinand behind]
 Before you would vouchsafe to call for the keys.
 We shall one day have my brothers take you napping.
 Methinks his presence, being now in court,
 Should make you keep your own bed; but you'll say
 Love mixed with fear is sweetest. I'll assure you
 You shall get no more children till my brothers
 Consent to be your gossips: have you lost your tongue?
[Sees Ferdinand who holds a poniard]
 'Tis welcome:
 For know, whether I am doomed to live or die,
 I can do both like a prince.

Ferdinand gives her a poniard

FERDINAND

Die then, quickly.
 Virtue, where art thou hid? What hideous thing
 Is it that doth eclipse thee?

DUCHESS

Pray, sir, hear me.

FERDINAND

Or is it true, thou art but a bare name,
 And no essential thing?

DUCHESS

Sir —

FERDINAND

Do not speak.

DUCHESS

No, sir.
 I will plant my soul in mine ears to hear you.

FERDINAND

O most imperfect light of human reason,
That mak'st us so unhappy, to foresee
What we can least prevent. Pursue thy wishes,
And glory in them: there's in shame no comfort
But to be past all bounds and sense of shame.

DUCHESS

I pray, sir, hear me: I am married.

FERDINAND

So.

DUCHESS

Haply, not to your liking: but for that,
Alas, your shears do come untimely now
To clip the bird's wings that's already flown.
Will you see my husband?

FERDINAND

Yes, if I could change
Eyes with a basilisk.

DUCHESS

Sure you came hither
By his confederacy.

FERDINAND

The howling of a wolf
Is music to thee, screech-owl; prithee peace.
Whate'er thou art, that hast enjoyed my sister
(For I am sure thou hear'st me), for thine own sake
Let me not know thee. I came hither prepared
To work thy discovery, yet am now persuaded
It would beget such violent effects
As would damn us both. I would not for ten millions
I had beheld thee; therefore use all means
I never may have knowledge of thy name.
Enjoy thy lust still, and a wretched life,
On that condition. And for thee, vile woman,
If thou do wish thy lecher may grow old
In thy embracements, I would have thee build
Such a room for him as our anchorites
To holier use inhabit. Let not the sun
Shine on him, till he's dead. Let dogs and monkeys
Only converse with him, and such dumb things
To whom nature denies use to sound his name.
Do not keep a paraquito, lest she learn it.
If thou do love him, cut out thine own tongue
Lest it bewray him.

Turn over for Section B

Section B: Later dramatic tragedies

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0 6

Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

'It is hard to feel sympathy for Willy Loman, as he ultimately lacks any of the qualities expected of a tragic hero.'

Discuss this view of the play.

[25 marks]

or

0 7

Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

How do you respond to the view that Blanche's main tragic flaw is her refusal to face reality?

[25 marks]

or

0 8

Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

'In the tragedy of *Hedda Gabler*, Lövborg is the only character who comes to any real recognition of his errors of judgement.'

How far do you agree with this view of the way that Lövborg is presented within the play?

[25 marks]

or

0 9

Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

What is the tragic significance of the characters of Pozzo and Lucky in *Waiting for Godot*?

[25 marks]

or

1 0

Brian Friel: *Translations*

'The English are caricatured; the Irish are idealised.'

How far do you agree with this judgement about the way the characters are presented in the tragedy *Translations*?

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

